

INTEROFFICE COMMUNICATION
San Mateo Police Department
Investigations Services

Date: March 24, 2021
To: All Department Personnel
From: Lt. Todd Mefford

Sergeant	_____
Lieutenant	_____
Field Ops Captain	_____
Support Captain	_____
Chief	_____

Re: ALPR HIT UPDATES AND EVIDENCE COLLECTION

The access to real-time ALPR data has shown to be an effective crime fighting tool as is apparent with the number of 10851 in-custodies, recoveries, identifications of vehicles involved in crimes, etc. When new technology is rolled out, there are always issues that surface and this memo will address some items the ALPR Committee has identified.

DELAY TIME FROM HIT TO OUR NOTIFICATION:

There have been instances of a delay in notification from 5 seconds to nearly 2-minutes. This is an indicator the vehicle is likely traveling away from our fixed ALPR cameras. Tailor your responses accordingly.

EVIDENCE COLLECTION:

Since mid-February, we have written 20 reports where the ALPRs played a role in identifying the presence of a stolen or felony vehicle which resulted in arrests, pursuits, or identified as suspect vehicles after the fact. Of those reports, only 7 reports included the ALPR hit as evidence. This equates to only 35% of the time we are collecting required evidence. ALPR hits that include the photo of your license plate and vehicle is only maintained by Flock and available to us for 30 days. After the 30 days, that photo is purged from the ALPR system. Remember that the ALPR hit is evidence and best practice is to capture that hit, document in your RIMS property entry and upload to Evidence.com.

RECOVERED VEHICLE STILL SHOWING AS STOLEN:

We experienced ALPR hits of recovered vehicles that still show as outstanding 10851 because they have not been removed from both SVS and NCIC. We encountered an instance where a vehicle was recovered, removed from SVS but not NCIC. Flock and PIPs pull hits from both SVS and NCIC independently, so if the hit is not removed from both systems we alerted that it is stolen.

CONSIDERATIONS WHEN TAKING POLICE ACTION ON HITS IN SVS OR NCIC

Vetting ALPR hits thoroughly reduces risk to our personal safety and liability. Errors in hits have been discovered recently such as recovered stolen vehicles still in system to felony want on a vehicle **to tow** that participated in sideshow activity. It is critical to verify the type of want on the vehicle before initiated police action.

REQUESTS FROM OUTSIDE AGENCIES:

If you receive a request from an outside law enforcement agency, we are giving you authorization to run the plates(s) through the ALPR platforms. You must obtain the requesting officer's name, agency, and case number. We must ensure they have the right/need to know. Requests received in Dispatch shall be routed to a Watch Commander for review and assignment to staff.

For questions or feedback regarding our ALPR platforms contact Sgt Pak or Officers O'Rourke, Trujillo and Venikov because we want to address any issues promptly.